Ford Motor Company

A. R. O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs
Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

November 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Owner Notification Program 00M12: Certain 1997 through 2000 Explorer/Mountaineer and 2001 Explorer Sport/Sport-Trac Vehicles Equipped with 4.0L SOHC Engines - Camshaft Chain Tensioner and Lower Intake Manifold Gasket Additional Coverage

OASIS: Yes
OWNER LIST: Yes
PARTS RETURN: No
PROGRAM TERMS: On the affected vehicles, this program extends the coverage for the 4.0L SOHC camshaft chain tensioner and lower intake manifold gasket to 6 years or 72,000 miles from the vehicle's warranty start date, whichever occurs first. This coverage will automatically transfer to subsequent owners. If the vehicle already has more than 72,000 miles, this coverage will last until April 30, 2001.

AFFECTED VEHICLES

- Certain 1997 through 2000 Explorer and Mountaineer vehicles equipped with 4.0L SOHC engines built at the Louisville Assembly Plant and St. Louis Assembly Plants from Job #1, 1997 through April 7, 2000.
- Certain 2001 Explorer Sport and Sport-Trac vehicles equipped with 4.0L SOHC engines built at the Louisville Assembly Plant from Job #1 through April 7, 2000.

SERVICE ACTION

- Owners of affected vehicles are being notified that Ford Motor Company is providing additional coverage for the affected engine camshaft chain tensioner and lower intake manifold gaskets.
- If either the camshaft chain tensioner or lower intake manifold gasket should require replacement, dealers are instructed to install both of these upgraded parts at the same time, at no charge to the customer.
- The no charge coverage for this condition is available for 6 years or 72,000 miles from the vehicle's warranty start date, whichever occurs first, and will automatically transfer to subsequent owners. If the vehicle already has more than 72,000 miles, this coverage will last until April 30, 2001.
- Please read Attachment IV (Question & Answer Sheet) for more details.

REASONS FOR THIS PROGRAM

We have incorporated enhancements into newly produced Explorer 4.0L SOHC engines. The long-term benefits of these improvements are being offered to prior customers.

The need to install a replacement camshaft chain tensioner is typically indicated by an engine rattling noise that occurs just after cold engine start up and goes away within a few minutes after the engine is running. Rough idle and low idle are symptoms which may, in some cases, indicate an intake manifold leak.

The condition of either or both of these components will not cause engine damage or failure, but may decrease the customer's satisfaction with their vehicle.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: ……Administrative Information and Refund Codes
Attachment II: ……Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: ……..Technical Information
Attachment IV: ……..Question & Answer Sheet
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Owner Notification Program 00M12
Certain 1997 through 2000 Explorer/Mountaineer and
2001 Explorer Sport/Sport-Trac Vehicles Equipped with 4.0L SOHC Engines –
Camshaft Chain Tensioner and Lower Intake Manifold Gasket Additional Coverage

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this program.

NOTE: When a claim is submitted on an "M" program the VIN number will remain in OASIS until the terms of the program expire.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII Manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund the cost of repairs for the camshaft chain tensioner and/or lower intake manifold gaskets made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer).

To qualify for the refund, the camshaft chain tensioner and/or lower intake manifold gasket must have been the causal part for the repair. All supporting documentation must be retained in accordance with the Warranty and Policy Manual.

Refer to ACESII Manual for Refund information. Enter claims using DWE:

Program Code:	00M12
Misc. Expense:	REFUND
Misc. Expense:	ADMIN
Misc. Expense:	0.2 Hr.

Owner Notification Program 00M12
Certain 1997 through 2000 Explorer/Mountaineer and
2001 Explorer Sport/Sport-Trac Vehicles Equipped with 4.0L SOHC Engines –
Camshaft Chain Tensioner and Lower Intake Manifold Gasket Additional Coverage

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time*
Replace Camshaft Chain Tensioner & Lower Intake Manifold Gaskets at the Same Time	00M12B	1.8 Hours

***Labor Time**: When replacing the camshaft chain tensioner, the upper intake manifold must be removed. To replace the lower intake manifold gaskets, the only additional steps are to remove the lower intake manifold bolts and replace the gaskets.

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirements through normal order processing channels as noted below:

Stock Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Interim Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Emergency Orders	First 30 days after launch	Call 1-800-325-5621
Emergency Orders	31 days after launch	Normal order process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
YL2Z-9E473-AA	Intake Manifold Gasket and Camshaft Chain Tensioner Kit	1 kit per vehicle

DOR/COR NUMBER

DOR/COR for this program is 50196

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, check or call your:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Owner Notification Program 00M12
Question and Answer Sheet

Q1: How do I know if a customer's vehicle requires a new camshaft chain tensioner or an intake manifold gasket?

ANSWER: TENSIONER: An engine rattling noise that occurs just after cold engine start up and goes away within a few minutes after the engine is running indicates the need to install a new camshaft chain tensioner.
INTAKE MANIFOLD GASKET: Rough idle and low idle are symptoms which may, in some cases, indicate an intake manifold leak.

Q2: Can either the camshaft chain tensioner or the lower intake manifold gasket cause an engine failure?

ANSWER: No. Neither of these components will cause engine failure. Therefore, engine replacement is not approved under this program.

Q3: Has any provision been made for diagnostic time?

ANSWER: No. The only diagnosis involved is to determine if the camshaft timing chain "rattle" is only during cold start up or if the engine has symptoms which may indicate an intake manifold leak as described in question #1.

Q4: Do you anticipate any "Related Damage"?

ANSWER: We do not expect any "Related Damage" claims because the affected parts have no damaging effect on other parts. Also, if the Technical Instructions (Attachment III) are followed, damage to other parts during the repair should be rare. In those rare cases if related damage occurred, if would be identified at the same time as the repair.

Q5: Why has replacement of the lower intake manifold gasket been included with the replacement of the camshaft chain tensioner?

ANSWER: First of all, both conditions basically affect the same volume of vehicles and the steps required to perform the repair are very similar. Secondly, typical intake manifold gasket leaks are masked by engine electronic adaptive strategies and, if the repair were not performed along with the camshaft chain tensioner, all of the customers would not receive the benefits of the new gasket.

Q6: Are the service procedures for the camshaft chain tensioner and intake manifold gasket the same as the Workshop Service procedures?

ANSWER: No. For example: The Technical Instructions for this program do not require draining the cooling system. Also, to prevent related damage and dealer comebacks, specific instructions are provided for the removal of the oil galley pipe plug. Therefore, it is important that the Technical Instructions for this program be carefully followed.

Owner Notification Program 00M12
Question and Answer Sheet

Q7: When I'm replacing the camshaft chain tensioner, how much more work is involved to replace the lower intake manifold gasket?

ANSWER: When replacing the camshaft chain tensioner, the upper intake manifold must be removed. To replace the lower intake manifold gasket, the only additional steps are to remove the lower intake manifold bolts and replace the gasket.

Q8: Why is the labor allowance only 1.8 hours when camshaft chain tensioner replacement in TSB 99-26-05 pays 1.6 hours and lower intake manifold gasket replacement pays 1.5 hours? Why don't I get paid 3.1 hours?

ANSWER: As mentioned in question #7, the only additional steps to replace the lower intake manifold gasket are to remove the manifold bolts and replace the gasket. This represents only 8 of the 50 steps required for this combined repair.

Also, keep in mind that without this program, most vehicles would not come in for both of these repairs. Therefore, the combined repair is in the best interest of the customer.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

00M12 (gasket and tensioner) December 2000

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, New Mexico 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

At Ford Motor Company, we are constantly working to improve our products. The reason for this letter is to tell you about a no charge coverage program.

What is the no charge coverage program?

Two internal components in newly produced Ford Explorer and Mercury Mountaineer 4.0L SOHC engines were recently enhanced to improve customer satisfaction. Ford would like to extend the long-term benefits of those two improvements to you by providing a no charge warranty extension, program number 00M12.

What parts of your vehicle are covered?...

Specifically, this program extends the warranty on the camshaft chain tensioner and the lower intake manifold gasket in certain 1997 to 2000 model Explorer and Mountaineer vehicles and 2001 Explorer Sport and Sport-Trac vehicles with 4.0L SOHC engines to a total of 6 years or 72,000 miles from the vehicle's warranty start date, whichever comes first. During this period, should either of these components require replacement, your Ford or Lincoln Mercury dealer is authorized to replace both at the same time at no charge to you. If your vehicle already has more than 72,000 miles, this coverage will last until April 30, 2001.

Refunds …

If the camshaft chain tensioner or lower intake manifold gasket was the cause of a repair which occurred before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your Ford or Lincoln Mercury dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. We stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We hope this no charge coverage confirms our commitment to your satisfaction. We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services.

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs